

Audio Editing

We all love music! It's merely tastes and the genres we listen to that distinguish us. Unfortunately, not all of us are talented enough to make music, but with the right software, anyone can edit and tweak their favourite songs. Whether it's mixing favourite tracks, or creating non-stop compilations, or even editing one's own little creations to make it sound more professional, there is software out there that will ease the task.

The first mistake most of us make is pessimism—as soon as we open an editing software, we see Sine waves and audio professional jargon, and are easily intimidated. However, *Digit* is here to show you that things are not as hard as they seem.

The two most popular Audio Editing software in use today are Sony Sound Forge (previously known as Sonic Foundry's Sound Forge) and Adobe Audition. Here we will give you tips and tricks on how to put both these software to good use.

Normalising A Track

When you open a track to edit, the first thing you should check for is 'clipping'. Some badly recorded tracks may have certain overtly loud sections, which will distort at loud volumes. These sections are said to 'clip'. These are easy to spot when viewing the track as a wave form.

The wave form view has a left and right channel wave for stereo tracks, and each track has an X axis, also called the infinity line. The Y axis limit, both towards the negative and positive, is 0 db (zero decibels) for both left and right channels. If a wave peak crosses this 0 db barrier, it is said to clip. In order to prevent it from clipping, you can normalise a track.

Normalising an audio clip converts the track in such a way that the highest

Tips & Tricks

SECRETS THAT KEEP YOU AHEAD IN THE RACE

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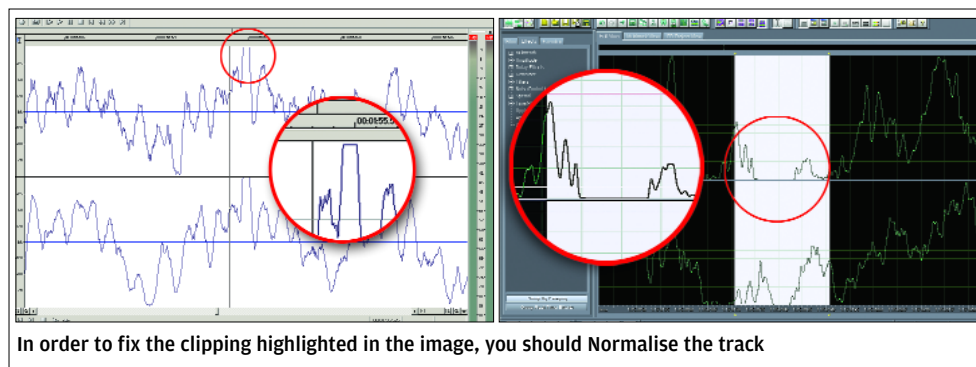
select the entire track by using [Ctrl] + [A]. Now go to "Process > Normalize...". Make sure that the Peak level radio button is checked and the slider is set to 0.00 db. Click OK to normalise.

Audition

Select a part of a track, or the whole track. Go to "Effects > Amplitude > Normalize...", make sure that 'Decibels Format' is checked and that 'Normalize to' is set to 0. Click OK to normalise.

Selecting Part Of A Track

When selecting a part of a track, you need to know where your selection should begin. For example, if you are looking to select an event, such as when the vocalist starts singing, or when the drum beat kicks in, you need to find the exact



peak (the loudest sound in the audio file) hits exactly 0 db. Now you will have distortion free audio.

Normalising can also be used on a track that is too soft—where the wave form never comes close to touching the 0 db line.

It can also be used to normalise just a section of an audio track.

Sound Forge

To normalise a track or a selection in Sound Forge, select the part of the track you want to normalise, or

spot. If you are even a little off, you will end up with a selection that does not follow the songs' tempo (beats per minute or bpm). If you select, say, six beats of an eight-beat song, you will not be able to loop your selection, or mix it with the same song—the

